

WHY I BUILT IT

Lattice

I can't stand what slide tools do to the people who use them. So I built one that doesn't.

THE PROBLEM

PowerPoint was revolutionary. Nobody has questioned it since.

Every tool after it copied the shape. A blank canvas. A master slide everything inherits from — until your first override sends the whole deck drifting. You still can't see what changed from one version to the next.

THE FIX

So I made the deck a plain text file.

You write the words in Markdown. The engine holds the structure; taste is built in, not left to chance. Change a line and that line is all that moves — and poor taste runs out of places to hide.

THE NAME IS THE PLAN

Four words, borrowed from people who work with their hands.

Function

Does it work? What the slide is for.

Form

What's its shape? A fixed layout, never a blank page.

Substance

What's it made of? The engine fills the slots.

Finish

How's it finished? One line sets the whole look.

— A tailor talks about form. A shoemaker talks about finish. I borrowed their words on purpose.

THE ONE RULE

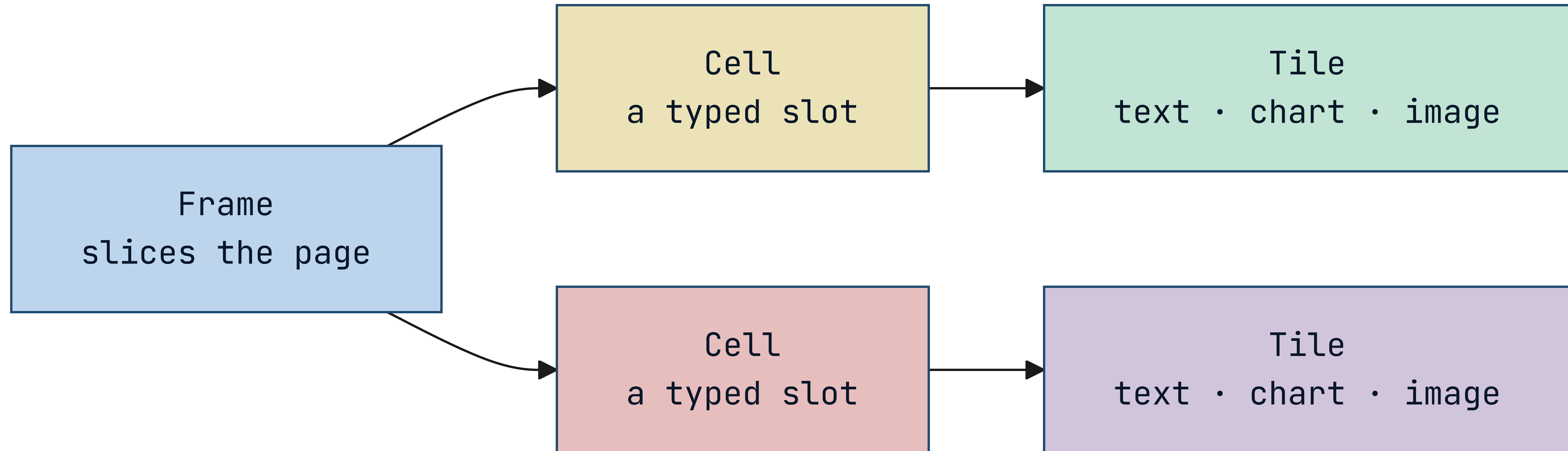
No layout ever names a colour.

Every colour comes from a token. Swap the palette and the colours change; the spacing, the type, the structure don't move an inch. Restyle the whole deck in one line.

FOR THE ENGINEERS IN THE ROOM

Every slide is three pieces.

A cell holds a tile, never another frame — I cut infinite nesting; it earns nothing on a slide.



TASTE, ENFORCED

The engine says no, so the deck stays clean.

Forty words a slide

Go past it and the engine tells you to split. The font never shrinks to make room.

Six bullets, then stop

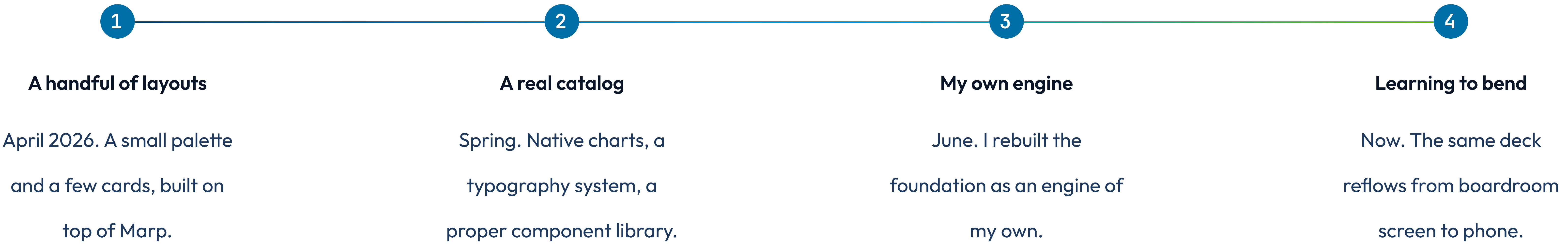
A slide isn't a document. The limit keeps it readable from the back row.

One idea per slide

When two thoughts are fighting, they each get their own page.

HOW IT GOT BUILT

It started as a stylesheet. It ended up an engine of its own.



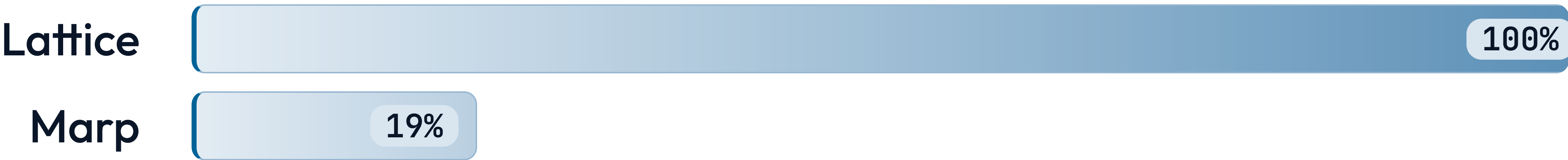
CREDIT WHERE IT'S DUE

Lattice stands on the shoulders of Marp.

Yuki Hattori's Marp helped me see the art of the possible. I fought it plenty — layered my own styles over it, dropped to plain CSS to get my way — but it had the best foundation to build on, and the method was the insight. For that, I'm grateful.

MEASURED AGAINST MARP

Rebuilt as my own, it renders five times faster.



– The same 79-slide deck: Marp at 208 milliseconds, Lattice at 39, and 42 megabytes lighter to install. Same method, my own engine underneath.

KEEPING IT HONEST

I had every layout graded twice, and the first scores stung.

One pass built each layout. A separate pass, blind to the first, tried to tear it down. The first score was a seven out of ten — built well, finished poorly. I set the bar at ten and didn't move it.

WHERE IT STANDS

Everything here ships today.

52

LAYOUTS, READY TO
DROP IN

14

COLOUR PALETTES, LIGHT
AND DARK

2,000+

TESTS THAT RUN ON
EVERY CHANGE

AA

CONTRAST THAT PASSES ON
EVERY SURFACE

WHAT'S NEXT

It's version one. Reflow is the next job.

One deck that reads right on a projector, a tablet, or a phone — without rewriting a word.

LATTICE · LATTICE.STYLE

THAT'S THE WHOLE IDEA

You write the words.
The structure holds.